

SOC Investigation Report

Date Report Raised: 2026-08-12

Incident Period: Not specified

Classification Alert Level: High

Executive Summary

The incident is classified as **Likely Malicious – Further Investigation Required** with **Medium confidence**. Defender telemetry describes suspicious authentication/credential-access activity; successful credential compromise is not independently confirmed. Evidence coverage is **81.8%**.

Incident Classification

- **Incident family:** authentication_identity
- **Routing confidence:** High
- **Routing evidence:** CredentialAccess source tactic, Brute-force/T1110 evidence, Authentication/logon terminology

Final Verdict

- **Classification:** Likely Malicious – Further Investigation Required
- **Confidence:** Medium
- **Source severity:** High

Findings

- **Host:** mts-dc.mts.local
- **Account:** mts\administrator
- **Internal IP:** 192.168.10.8
- **External/Public IP:** 40.70.80.252
- **IPv6:** fe80::b350:3b7f:2ded:e3f1
- **Observed originating remote IP:** Not established from available telemetry
- **First activity:** 2026-07-26 10:23:43 UTC
- **Alert generated:** 2026-07-26 10:24:41 UTC
- **Incident updated:** 2026-07-26 10:24:43 UTC
- **Status:** New
- **Detection source:** Microsoft Defender Advanced Threat Protection

5Ws and 1H

- **Who:** Affected account: mts\administrator on host mts-dc.mts.local.
- **What:** Microsoft Defender detected suspicious authentication activity associated with credential-access/brute-force behaviour. Successful credential compromise is not independently confirmed.

- **When:** 2026-07-26 10:23:43 UTC
- **Where:** Host: mts-dc.mts.local; Internal IP: 192.168.10.8; Public IP: 40.70.80.252.
- **Why:** Defender correlated suspicious credential-access/authentication activity with the affected account; successful compromise remains unconfirmed.
- **How:** The alert indicates suspicious authentication activity. Precise logon type and authentication mechanism require supporting Windows Security, identity and network telemetry.

Observed Indicators

- **Vendor Reference URL:** Microsoft Defender alert link
- **Vendor Reference URL:** Azure Sentinel incident link
- **Host / Device IP:** 192.168.10.8
- **Defender Device Identifier:** cfbb31e8e882f054c2b61e1be9fe5cfd111b4a0f
- **Host / Device IP:** 40.70.80.252
- **Host / Device IPv6:** fe80::b350:3b7f:2ded:e3f1
- **Vendor Reference Domain:** security.microsoft.com
- **Vendor Reference Domain:** portal.azure.com

Confirmed Malicious IOCs

- None confirmed from supplied evidence.

Threat Intelligence

Provider Status

- **VirusTotal:** Checked 1 eligible indicator(s).
- **AbuseIPDB:** Checked 1 eligible indicator(s).
- **OTX:** Checked 1 eligible indicator(s).

Enrichment Results

40.70.80.252 — Device / Host Attribute

- **VirusTotal:** No Detections (0 malicious, 0 suspicious, 91 undetected). Registered owner: Microsoft Corporation (ASN 8075).
- **AbuseIPDB:** Abuse Confidence Score 0; 0 abuse report(s). ISP: Microsoft Corporation.
- **OTX:** Unknown (confidence: Low).
- **Assessment:** Reputation findings are contextual only. This indicator remains a host/device attribute unless separate evidence establishes attacker attribution.

Enrichment exclusions: 24 provider/indicator combinations were excluded from external lookup because they were non-public addresses, device identifiers, or vendor/reference indicators. Detailed exclusion records remain available in the analyst Threat Intel view.

Interpretation note: Threat-intelligence reputation is contextual evidence only. It does not change an indicator's incident role by itself. A device public IP, for example, remains a host attribute unless separate evidence identifies it as attacker infrastructure.

MITRE ATT&CK

- **T1110 – Brute Force** (Credential Access) | Confidence: High

Timeline

- **2026-07-26 10:23:43 UTC** — Suspicious authentication activity recorded | Source: Microsoft Defender telemetry
- **2026-07-26 10:24:41 UTC** — Microsoft Defender alert generated | Source: Microsoft Defender telemetry
- **2026-07-26 10:24:43 UTC** — Incident created/updated in Microsoft security environment | Source: Microsoft Defender telemetry

Recommendations

- Identify the originating remote IP referenced by the Defender alert using Defender device/network evidence.
- Review Windows Security Event IDs 4624 and 4625 to validate successful and failed logons around the alert time.
- Review Windows Security Event IDs 4723, 4724 and 4738 for password resets, password changes and account modifications.
- Validate whether the mts\administrator sign-in was expected and authorised.
- Review the Defender device timeline immediately before and after the alert for post-authentication activity.
- Review Kerberos/NTLM telemetry including Event IDs 4768, 4769 and 4776 where available.
- Correlate firewall, VPN and network-access logs with the alert timestamp.
- Once reliable remote indicators are identified, hunt across other devices and accounts for related activity.
- If unauthorised access is confirmed, reset affected credentials, invalidate sessions and consider host isolation.

Investigation Scope and Evidence Boundary

SOC Augmentor analysed only the evidence supplied to the application. Conclusions are limited to that evidence and any enrichment results explicitly obtained for eligible indicators.

- Facts requiring telemetry that was not supplied remain unestablished.
- Unavailable data sources must not be described as though they were searched.

Evidence-state terminology: 'Not present in supplied evidence' means the required data was not contained in the artefact provided to SOC Augmentor; it does not mean the activity was searched for and not found. 'Not found during investigation' should only be used when the relevant data source was actually reviewed.

Evidence Gaps and Investigation Limitations

- Originating remote IP: not established from supplied telemetry or investigation evidence.
- Supporting Windows Security logs: not established from supplied telemetry or investigation evidence.

Validation / Contradiction Checks

- No major contradictions detected between retained source evidence and final classification.